

Directions: Each passage is followed by five questions. Read each passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. For each questions four probable answer bearing letters (1), (2), (3) and (4) are given. Only one out of these is correct.

Passage 1

Mahatma Gandhi is unanimously looked upon as the greatest man of the world today. This is no underserved epithet. The ideals of self-sacrifice and love of truth which he has brought before the world's eyes are simply adorable. His message of truth has awakened the sleeping population of India. But Gandhiji, like all other personages, belongs not only to a particular country but the whole world. His philanthropic mission is exemplary in the history of mankind. It is no wonder if the future progeny will look upon him as the incarnation of God himself.

1. What has awakened the sleeping population of India?

- (1) Gandhiji's message of truth
- (2) Gandhiji's faith in non-violence
- (3) Gandhiji's ideal of self-sacrifice
- (4) Gandhiji's vision of free India

2. Like all other personages Gandhiji

- (1) belongs to the whole world
- (2) likes truth
- (3) believes only in non-violence
- (4) is worshipped as God

3. What does the expression 'unanimously looked upon' mean?

- (1) Loved by all
- (2) Regarded by all
- (3) Decided by all
- (4) Deputed by all

4. It is no wonder if the future generation will look upon Mahatma Gandhi as

- (1) a great man of India
- (2) a lover of human kind
- (3) the incarnation of God himself
- (4) a divine person

5. The two ideals Gandhiji brought before the world are

- (1) self-sacrifice and love of truth
- (2) truth and non-violence
- (3) self-sacrifice and non-violence
- (4) truth and tolerance

Passage 2

It is strange that ducks mostly swim in water, though their feathers keep dry. They swim in water for long hours and sometimes plunge into water but the feathers still keep dry. What is the secret of it? There is a small oil limb produced in the root of a duck's tail. The duck expels oil by pressing this limb which spreads over their feathers. Generally, all the birds have this oil producing limb but it is well developed in

an aquatic animal, there is no sweat producing limb in birds.

1. The above passage, describes about a duck's

- (1) sweat limb
- (2) oily feathers
- (3) oil limbs
- (4) secret of remaining dry

2. The peculiarity of ducks is that they

- (1) can swim for long
- (2) can swim very fast
- (3) can plunge quickly
- (4) can remain dry inspite of swimming in water

3. The oil limb of a duck is

- (1) on its back
- (2) in its tail
- (3) in its feathers
- (4) in its feet

4. "What is the secret of it?" Which action of a duck is represented by these words?

- (1) Swimming
- (2) Plunging
- (3) Remaining dry
- (4) Remaining in water for a long time

5. The oil limb is

- (1) not developed in all birds
- (2) not found in all ducks
- (3) not found in all birds
- (4) well developed in only some ducks

Passage 3

The Sahara is the biggest desert in the world. It stretches across the whole of North Africa. The Arabian desert is also a very large desert. In India too, there is a desert called Thar desert in Rajasthan. Life in a desert is tough. The days are very hot and nights are cold.

1. The biggest desert in the world is in

- (1) India
- (2) Africa
- (3) Arabia
- (4) America

2. Date palms grow in

- (1) plains
- (2) hilly regions
- (3) deserts
- (4) snowy regions

3. In desert regions

- (1) there is no rainfall
- (2) it rains heavily
- (3) there is enough rain
- (4) there is a little rain

4. The antonym of the word 'hot' is

- (1) cold
- (2) warm
- (3) pleasant
- (4) difficult

5. Very few trees grow in deserts because
- (1) most trees need water to grow
 - (2) there is sand all around
 - (3) nights are very cold
 - (4) there is no one to take care of trees

Passage 4

Mr. Verma is a typist in the town hospital. He lives near the hospital. He, his wife and their daughter, Leela, are a small and happy family. They are hard working. Mr. Verma's wife, Smt. Aruna is busy from morning to evening. She has no servant. She gets up before sunrise and begins her work. She sweeps the rooms, washes the vessels and cooks the food. Leela wakes up before 6 o'clock. She helps her mother with her work in the kitchen. She brings water from the well and washes the clothes. So, she is busy too. She does her homework after breakfast and leaves for school at nine.

1. Who is a typist in the town hospital?
 - (1) Smt. Aruna
 - (2) Leela
 - (3) Mr. Verma
 - (4) None of these
2. Who is busy from morning to evening?
 - (1) Smt. Aruna
 - (2) Mr. Verma
 - (3) Leela
 - (4) None of these
3. Smt. Aruna has no

 - (1) room
 - (2) food
 - (3) work
 - (4) servant

4. Who brings water from the well?
 - (1) Leela
 - (2) Smt. Aruna
 - (3) Mr. Verma
 - (4) Servant
5. At what time does Leela get up?
 - (1) After 6 o'clock
 - (2) Before 6 o'clock
 - (3) At 6 o'clock
 - (4) None of these

Passage 5

There was once a boy who would never pay any attention to his studies. His parents sent him to school but he took to playing on the road and did not care for the opinion of even those friends who helped him in danger. One day a gentleman who was on the look out for a boy-servant, happened to come across him, wandering all alone in the street. He carried him away to a different town and made him work day and night as a servant. Now, the boy repented his folly and one day while his master was fast asleep, he slipped away and after a good deal of trouble, reached home. He

applied himself to his books now and rose, in after life, to be a great man.

1. Who took to playing on the road?
 - (1) A servant
 - (2) A boy
 - (3) Parents
 - (4) A gentleman
2. Who helped him in danger?
 - (1) Friends
 - (2) Parents
 - (3) A gentleman
 - (4) A boy-servant
3. What did the gentleman make him to do day and night?
 - (1) Play
 - (2) Study
 - (3) Work
 - (4) Sleep
4. "The boy slipped away when the master was"
 - (1) working
 - (2) sleeping
 - (3) playing cards
 - (4) having lunch
5. The opposite gender for the word 'gentleman' is
 - (1) gentlewoman
 - (2) lady
 - (3) gentlemen
 - (4) madam

Passage 6

The Earth is known as a 'watery planet' because it is the only planet of the solar system containing water in abundance. The presence of life on our planet is mainly due to water and air. More than two-thirds of the Earth's surface is covered with water. Oceans contain about 97% of the total water available on the Earth's surface. The fresh water found in the form of snow and ice on the ground and water in lakes and rivers accounts for the remaining 3%. Ocean water is always saline. Hence, it is not of direct use to man. It is however, important as it provides the bulk of water vapour that enters the atmosphere where it forms clouds.

1. The presence of life on our Earth is due to
 - (1) good food and crops
 - (2) good roads and motor cars
 - (3) air and water
 - (4) sunlight
2. surface of the Earth is covered with water.
 - (1) More than half
 - (2) More than two-thirds
 - (3) Less than half
 - (4) Less than two-thirds
3. Spot the correct statement.
 - (1) Man uses ocean water directly
 - (2) Fresh water is always saline

- (3) Ocean water is always saline
 (4) Earth gets water from Sun
4. Oceans contain
 (1) 50% of the total water
 (2) 3% of the total water
 (3) 97% of the total water
 (4) ice and snow
5. Which one of the following is not a synonym of 'abundance'?
- (1) Plenty
 (2) Ample
 (3) Lack
 (4) Riches

Passage 7

In our approach to life, be it pragmatic or otherwise a basic fact that confronts us squarely and unmistakably is the desire for peace, security and happiness. Different forms of life at different levels of existence make- up the teeming denizens of this Earth of ours. And no matter whether they belong or the higher groups such as human beings or to the lower groups such as animals, all beings primarily seek peace, comfort and security. Life is as dear to a mute creature as it is to a man. Even the lowliest insect strives for protection against dangers that threaten its life. Just as each one of us wants to live and not to die, so do all other creatures.

1. The author's main point is that
 (1) different forms of life are found on Earth
 (2) different levels of existence are possible in Nature
 (3) peace and security are the chief goals of all living beings
 (4) even the weakest creature struggles to preserve its life
2. How is life of a mute creature?
 (1) They are ignorant
 (2) It is as dear as a man itself
 (3) Cannot be forecast
 (4) It is comfortable
3. According to the passage, the higher groups are mentioned as
 (1) all the animals
 (2) all human beings
 (3) under threaten
 (4) mute like insects
4. The lowliest insect strives for
 (1) food
 (2) existence
 (3) peace
 (4) protection
5. Who does want to die?
 (1) One of us and all other creature
 (2) Happiness, peace
 (3) Human beings

- (4) Lower groups of animals

Passage 8

One of the major crises facing the country is the looming water shortage. A recent report of the UN has named India among the worst countries for poor quality of water. The report ranks 122 countries according to the quality of their water as well as their ability and commitment to improve the situation. Belgium is considered the worst basically because of the quality of its ground water. Rains failed in most parts of India last year and the vast areas of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Andhra and Odisha were in the grip of devastating drought. People without water turn desperate and violent. Villagers in Rajasthan last year attacked the Food Corporation godowns. Worse may be coming. With man refusing to control pollution (America, the world's greatest polluter, refuses to cooperate with, other countries) the world's getting hotter. This means that the great ice shelves (weighing billions of tonnes) of the Antarctic are collapsing. We cannot even conceptualise the dangerous consequences.

1. Belgium, is suffering acutely because
 (1) the sluggish pace of its economy
 (2) the discharge of industrial effluents
 (3) quality of its ground water
 (4) rising cost of living
2. Villagers in Rajasthan attacked Food Corporation godowns because of
 (1) low prices offered to them for wheat
 (2) refusal of Food Corporation to buy wheat from the local farmers
 (3) no financial help from the government bodies
 (4) shortage of water
3. What major crises is the country facing today?
 (1) Rainfall
 (2) Water shortage
 (3) Drought
 (4) Violent
4. The word 'Devastating' means
 (1) Blessed
 (2) Disastrous
 (3) Fortunate
 (4) Peace
5. The world's greatest polluter country is
 (1) India
 (2) America
 (3) Belgium
 (4) Unknown

Passage 9

In Asia and much of Third World, trees are still destroyed in the old-fashioned way: they are cut down for fuel and cropland. In Europe, there is new and potentially more deadly culprit, The Germans call it 'Waldsterben', the dying forest syndrome. But the

disease is far more than a German phenomenon. Since, it was first observed by German scientists in the autumn of 1980, the mysterious malady has raced across Europe, blighting woods in countries as far apart as Sweden and Italy. Explanations for the epidemic range from a cyclic change in the environment to a baffling form of tree cancer. But the most convincing evidence points to air pollution. Indeed, saving the rapidly deteriorating forests of Europe will probably require a two-pronged strategy: an offensive campaign that includes the breeding of pollution-immune trees and a defensive scheme that calls for reductions in toxic emissions. But both will require more money than is currently being spent on such measures, as well as total commitment to protecting the environment.

1. According to this passage, which one of the following statements is correct?

- (1) There is less damage in Asia than in Europe
- (2) More forests are dying in Germany than anywhere else in Europe
- (3) A cyclic change in the environment is responsible for deforestation
- (4) Air pollution is the main culprit of destroying European forests

2. Saving the trees of European forests

- (1) should not be difficult because of the advances in experimental research
- (2) appears to be a hopeless task and therefore pointless to undertake
- (3) requires a much bigger budget
- (4) demands vigilance and punitive measures against those who cut down the trees

3. The dying forest syndrome is a disease that

- (1) is peculiar to the forests of Asia
- (2) has spread rapidly over the forests of Europe
- (3) is confined to the forests of Germany
- (4) has affected forests all over the world

4. The writer suggests that

- (1) it is no longer possible to grow trees in industrialised areas
- (2) pollution-immune trees will absorb toxic emissions
- (3) all pollution-prone trees should be destroyed
- (4) it is not possible to grow trees that remain unaffected by pollution

5. The writer's approach toward the problem of forest devastation is one of

- (1) tolerance
- (2) indifference
- (3) well thought-out strategy
- (4) despondency

Passage 10

Thomas Edison was an American scientist. As a little boy, he used to sell newspapers on the American

railway station. Most of the time, he was found in the telegraph office watching the operators at work. One day, he saw the station master's little boy in danger of meeting an accident. Jumping forward, he saved the child and in return for the service the station master taught him all about telegraphy. Many hours did the young man spend in research and to him we owe some of the greatest comforts of modern life. He was only twenty years old when he invented the gramophone.

1. Which country did Thomas Edison belong to?

- (1) India
- (2) China
- (3) America
- (4) Japan

2. Where did he sell newspapers?

- (1) At the railway station
- (2) At the airport
- (3) At the bus-stop
- (4) At the mall

3. What did he do in the telegraph office?

- (1) Talk to the people
- (2) Help the people
- (3) Fill the details
- (4) Watch the operators

4. What was his age when he invented the gramophone?

- (1) Eighteen
- (2) Twenty-four
- (3) Twelve
- (4) Twenty

5. Who was in danger?

- (1) Thomas Edison
- (2) The station master
- (3) The station master's little boy
- (4) None of the above